

Remember my name!

Each IPL has thrown up some **young heroes.** Here are six cricketers who have lit up the competition this year.

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Abhishek Sharma

— **Sunrisers Hyderabad**

Abhishek Sharma and Travis Head have formed an intimidating opening partnership for Sunrisers Hyderabad (SRH), leading the team to three 250-plus totals this season.

Abhishek has been a part of the Hyderabad-based franchise since 2018. However, his explosive batting at the top of the order this year has helped him gain more attention. His opening performance was so impressive that his name was doing the rounds as a possible option for the opening slot for India's T20 World Cup squad. The left-hander's 16-ball 50 against Mumbai Indians was the fastest by an SRH batter. Against Delhi Capitals, Abhishek scored 46 runs off just 12 balls, falling agonisingly short of equalling the record for the fastest fifty in IPL (13 balls), held by Yashasvi Jaiswal. Abhishek's preference for spin is evident from his strike rate of 236 against spinners in IPL 2024, compared to 188.50 against pacers, despite his batting position suggesting a liking for pace.

Innings: 10 | Runs: 315 | Average: 31.50 |
Strike Rate: 208.60 | HS: 63 | 50s: 1



Riyan Parag

— **Rajasthan Royals**

Riyan Parag rode a successful domestic campaign, where he was the top run-scorer in the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy, to script a remarkable turnaround with Rajasthan Royals (RR) in the IPL.

After multiple middling seasons with Royals, batting mostly in the lower middle order and scoring only 600 runs in 54 games, Riyan has turned a corner with his promotion to the number four position.

Riyan has played a crucial role in Rajasthan Royals' batting during the middle overs, contributing significantly to its impressive performance this season. In 10 innings, he has scored four half-centuries and is currently the leading run-scorer for RR. With 409 runs this year, he has also become the highest-scoring uncapped player in the history of the IPL.

Innings: 9 | Runs: 409 | Average: 58.42 |
Strike Rate: 159.14 | HS: 84* | 50s: 4